COMMISSIONER from 1A

Commissioner Andy Anderson said Russell had 32 years of experience with major corporations doing finance and accounting as well as the financial aspects of government.

The finance director will be responsible for streamlining county procedures and policies along with the purchasing manager, yet to be hired, who will report to him.

Russell was not on hand to say whether he would accept the position but Anderson said he felt confident he would.

The board also voted on numerous rezoning requests.

• Watson Road Partners LLC residential rezoning request on Watson Road was approved with three added conditions: a portion of the drive in dispute will be deeded over to W. R. Hyer, a 100-foot-long, 6-foot-high privacy fence will be constructed at the rear of lots 80, 81, and 82 and disclosure to all prospective homeowners that the adjacent landowner, Amos, had as sewage land application operation. The 80-acre subdivision will have houses with a minimum 1,500 square feet of heated floor space and two-car garages.

• McCar Development Corporation' request for residential zoning on 73 acres on Bethel Road was also approved.

The board went into closed session to discuss personnel, land acquisition and litigation.

JURY from 1A

– "Obviously employees feel more at liberty to discuss morale with the Grand Jury than the board who could ultimately relinquish their positions."

– "We have collectively polled a majority of the departments in county government and the response has been consistently the same.

In its Nov. 5 presentments, the July term of the Forsyth County Grand Jury made recommendations about employee morale, ethics and the need to improve communication between commissioners.

POST from 1A

Bruckner also questioned why taxpayers should pay for this new position.

Commissioner Andy Anderson said the issue had already been settled and volunteers should concentrate on their work.

"This issue is closed. The majority of the board voted for it," said Anderson.

Anderson said Slavin Management Consultants had formalized a range of $48,000-$71,000 for the position.

Deputy hit by suspect's car

By Michael Kurtz
Staff Writer

Sheriff's Office investigators are looking for a Cumming man who allegedly struck a deputy with his car during a traffic stop Saturday night.

Sgt. Lou Mitcham stopped a white Pontiac Grand Prix on Club Drive about 9 p.m in connection with another call.

While Mitcham was questioning the suspect, he reportedly turned the car back on and tried to leave the scene.

Mitcham was knocked to the ground by the car.

He pursued the suspect to the intersection of Club Drive and Scott Road where the driver wrecked off the side of the road.

The suspect fled on foot into the woods adjacent to the intersection. Mitcham could not follow because of injuries he had sustained, state reports.

Two other deputies and a K-9 unit searched the area but could not find the suspect.

Mitcham drove himself to Baptist North Hospital where he was treated for torn ligaments in his knee. He was released Sunday and is expected to return to work next week.

Georgia State Patrol investigators impounded the Grand Prix and are investigating the case.

The suspect was identified as Charles Warner.

Warrants were issued for aggravated assault on a peace officer and felony obstruction. He is also wanted for questioning in a child molestation case.

Anyone with information should contact the Sheriff's Office Crime Stoppers hot line at 888-7308.

HOOKUPS from 1A

County water department director Tim Perkins told investigators all the problems except one had been corrected.

Perkins furnished a list of problem areas to the Sheriff's Office at the advice of the county attorney.

He said there have been past problems with illegal hookups, but a new policy requiring the purchase of a water meter before issuing a building permit has alleviated them.

Col. Tommy Townsend of the Sheriff's Office said investigators are looking into Kieffer's situation.

BOND from 1A

Milton Frady did not attend the Nov. 2 funeral of his son. At the time, Sara Frady said her son was worried about being arrested for the outstanding warrants.

Milton Frady was questioned by investigators after turning himself in, but could not be released as a condition of his bond until a company was found to provide an electronic monitoring system.

Milton Frady's attorney, Michael Hauptman, said many of the companies were wary of taking on a high-profile case.

Sentinel Monitoring Corporation, a Marietta-based firm, agreed to provide security late last week.

Milton Frady will wear an ankle bracelet which is wired directly to the security company. In addition, surveillance cameras will be set up in and around the residence.

Frady was also ordered to post a $22,400 bond and pay for the cost of deputies transporting him home. No court date has been set for the 1995 charges.

Meanwhile, authorities say they are still pursuing leads in their investigation into the murder of Levi Frady.

The second man in the sketch police released last week remains unidentified. Investigators say the man is not considered a suspect but is thought to be a potential witness.

They said they simply want to talk with him to see if he has any information.

The man in a third artist sketch, which was never released to the public, has been identified. Special Agent in Charge of the Gainesville Georgia Bureau of Investigation office, Jim Hallman, said agents interviewed the man over the weekend and are pursuing leads from information he provided.

Hallman declined to identify the man, who was seen in the wooded area near the location where Levi was murdered. The description of the man was provided by a citizen police talked to during a roadblock in the area last week.

"The case is still progressing," Hallman said. "We've got a number of leads remaining to check, and we're doing that as quickly as possible."

PLANE from 1A

The fire department responded to the scene and secured a fuel leak coming from the plane. There was no fire or explosion.

An FAA spokesman said investigators do not know what caused the plane to go down or why it was bouncing on the runway.

FAA and NTSB investigators were at the airport Monday to look over the scene.

No charges have been filed in the case. Any charges against the pilot or airport would come from the FAA.

This is the second plane to go down in Forsyth County this year.

In March, a Piper P.A. 22-150 was forced to make an emergency landing in an abandoned lot near 1595 Union Hill Road due to mechanical difficulties.

No one was injured in that incident.

Sheriff's incident reports summary

By Michael Kurtz
Staff Writer

Two boats were reportedly burglarized between Nov. 2-8.

A tool box, volt meter, boat cushion and $1,000 worth of tools were stolen off a boat in storage at the Mashburn Boat Storage on Mashburn Drive.

A Mercury boat motor was taken off a boat docked at a Lakeshore Drive address. It is valued at $2,082.

Sheriff's Office investigator David McWhorter said boat engine theft usually increases in the fall, but this is the highest rate he has seen.

"We have had 35 motors taken since the first of the year to date," said McWhorter. "None of them have been recovered."

McWhorter said boat engine theft is relatively simple since tracks and other evidence is not left behind.

Witnesses to several of the thefts said they heard a boat approaching at the time of the theft. Several other have reported seeing a pontoon boat in the area.

McWhorter said notices have gone to other counties on Lake Lanier to watch for a pontoon boat with a lift in front to take the motor.

Mercruiser brand motors are the most popular target, however, every type of motor has been taken. In two instances, expensive motors were taken and replaced with cheaper brands.

McWhorter said the motors are not being sold in pawn shops around the area. He said he thinks there may be a chop-shop for boat motors operating in the area.

In a chop-shop, automobiles, engines and other stolen machinery are stripped and sold for parts.

Anyone with information on boat engine thefts should call the Sheriff's Office at 781-2200.

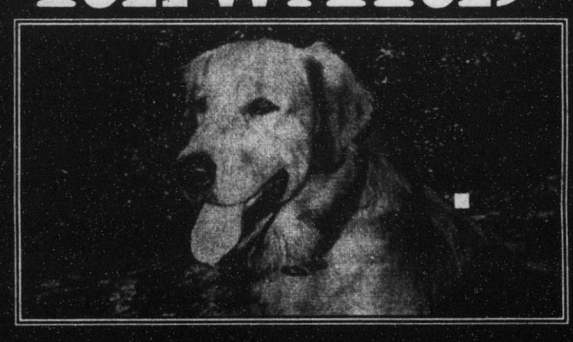
Other incidents reported to the Sheriff's Office include:

• A ladder, drill, Coleman cooler, brass bookend, two pictures and two shelves were stolen from an under-construction Buckhollow Drive home between Sept. 13 and Nov. 8. The items are valued at $1,055.

• Someone stole Viper radial tires and Toyota sports wheels off a 1988 Toyota Corolla parked at a McFarland Road address on Nov. 8. A Smith and Wesson 9mm handgun and a purse were also taken out of the car.

• A 1998 Yamaha four-wheeler and two deer stands were stolen from a Naughan Drive address between Nov. 6-7. The deer stands were attached to the four-wheeler.

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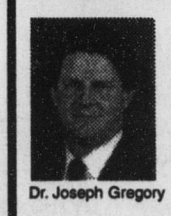
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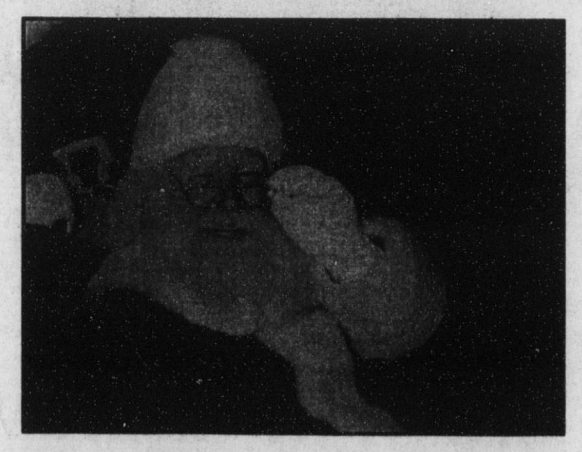
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For Wednesday's paper retail and classified display ads are due by 5 p.m. Friday.
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